Performance Calibration: Manager Preparation Guide

This article covers how to prepare for and run a calibration session, from entering provisional ratings through to recording the outcome. Treat what is discussed in the session as confidential.

What calibration is for

Calibration is a consistency check across managers, not a ranking exercise and not a forced distribution. The question in the room is whether two colleagues doing comparable work in comparable conditions would receive comparable ratings from different managers. If the answer is no, the group works out why.

Before the session

1. Enter a provisional rating for every direct report in Workday by December 1.
2. For each provisional rating, prepare three concrete examples drawn from the work. An example names the deliverable, the difficulty, and the outcome.
3. Review the self-review before you finalise the provisional rating, not after.
4. Identify anyone whose scope changed mid-year, who was on leave, or who carried a significant unplanned workload, and note it.
5. Submit your preparation packet to your HR Business Partner at least seven (7) business days before the session.

> Seven business days is a hard cut-off. Packets that arrive late are scheduled into the overflow session in mid-January, which delays the colleague's review conversation.

Running the session

Minutes	Agenda item	Led by
0 - 5	Ground rules and confidentiality reminder	HR facilitator
5 - 20	Walk the provisional ratings	Each manager
20 - 35	Discuss outliers and scope differences	Group
35 - 42	Bias check against the rating definitions	HR facilitator
42 - 45	Confirm decisions and name open items	HR facilitator

The session is scheduled for forty-five (45) minutes. If the group cannot reach a decision on a colleague within the session, the item is recorded as open and the HR facilitator responds within two (2) business days.

What stays in the room

- Comparisons between named colleagues stay in the room and are never shared.
- The colleague receives the agreed rating and the examples that support it.

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- Notes about another manager's team are not retained after the session.
- Never record a health reason, leave usage, or accommodation in a performance note.

Disagreement

If you disagree with the group's conclusion, say so in the session and ask the facilitator to record it. You then have three (3) business days after the session to escalate in writing to your HR Business Partner. Silence in the session is treated as agreement.

Things that are never a basis for a rating

- Approved leave of any kind, including paid sick leave and parental leave
- A pending or granted accommodation
- Participation in an investigation
- Working a hybrid schedule that meets the policy minimum

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